

Delta Electronics India launches Mumbai's first DC fast charger for EVs

Electronics manufacturing company Delta Electronics India has launched Mumbai's first DC fast charger station for electric vehicles (EVs). The charging station at Maharashtra Mantralaya has a capacity of 15kW. It is made based on Bharat EV specifications standard. It will offer solutions to all kind of e-buses, e-cars and commercial EVs, including newly-launched e-cars such as Tata Tigor and Mahindra Verito.

Mercedes-Benz to make EVs in Pune

Mercedes-Benz, the world's top luxury carmaker, plans to manufacture EVs in India at its factory at Chakan in Pune, reported *Times of India*. The German auto major feels that India will emerge as one of the key markets for electrics in the coming years. This is in line with the government's focus on non-combustion technologies as well as efforts to tackle the rising pollution across top cities.

Panasonic finally breaks even in India

Panasonic India broke even in 2016-17, posting a net profit of ₹ 722 million, as per its latest regulatory filings with Registrar of Companies, reported *The Economic Times*. The company's consumer electronics, home appliances and automotive businesses turned profitable, leading to overall profitability in its ninth year of operation after making a re-entry into the Indian market.

Mirc Electronics begins manufacturing in Wada

Mumbai-based Mirc Electronics, the company that makes Onida brand of televisions and appliances, has started manufacturing television panels at its Wada facility for captive and non-captive purposes. The decision was taken after the government increased customs duty on import of finished television panels for encouraging domestic manufacturing. Initial capacity of panels would be half a million units per annum.

Environment Ministry allows import of second-hand machinery for electronics

According to the latest notification by

Ministry of Environment, Forests and Climate Change (MoEF), used plant machinery having a residual life of at least five years would not require explicit permission from Hazardous and Other Waste Committee. Until now, handset and other component assembly and manufacturing units had to wait for the committee that meets every few months.

Titan sells electronics manufacturing unit to Danlaw Technologies

IT firm Danlaw Technologies India Ltd has announced the acquisition of 100 per cent stake in Titan Time Products Ltd (TTPL), a unit of Titan Co. Ltd, for US\$ 2.72 million. As per company reports, the acquisition will give Danlaw a manufacturing base for products designed in-house. It will also help with backwards integration.

Prime Minister inaugurates India's first integrated greenfield smart city

Prime Minister Narendra Modi recently inaugurated India's first integrated greenfield smart city project at Naya Raipur, the capital of Chhattisgarh. Schneider Electric announced the implementation of an integrated command and control centre along with utility management system (electrical and water SCADA) and an intelligent building management system there. The integrated project has been executed by Schneider Electric along with consortium partner, IL&FS Technologies Ltd.

Defence minister inaugurates BEL office in Vietnam

Defence minister, Nirmala Sitharaman, recently inaugurated the first representative office of Navratna Defence PSU Bharat Electronics Ltd (BEL) in Vietnam. She handed over the symbolic key of the office to Gowtama M.V., chairman and managing director, BEL, during Vietnam-India Defence Industry Business Meeting in Hanoi, in the presence of His Excellency P. Harish, ambassador of India to the Socialist Republic of Vietnam, Dr Ajay Kumar, secretary (Defence Production), and other senior officials of India and Vietnam defence forces.

communique said that the scheme entails providing 2G + 4G mobile coverage in identified uncovered areas of Meghalaya, as well as 2G + 4G seamless mobile coverage along national highways in the state.

MeitY launches internship scheme for tech students

In an effort to enhance the skills of the youth, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) has launched Digital India Internship Scheme portal. The internship scheme will enable young students to learn about the transformative Digital India initiative. It will also teach them the country's technology policy and the decision-making process of the government.

Proposed areas of internship include R&D in electronics and IT, cyber law/IT Act, digital forensics, malware analysis, mobile governance, cloud computing, digital literacy, software/hardware industry promotion and digital payments. Under this scheme, a monthly token of ₹ 10,000 will be offered to interns as remuneration.

Huawei to assemble PCBs in India

Chinese handset and telecom-equipment maker, Huawei, has plans to put together components such as printed circuit boards (PCBs) in India, to beat high import duties and a volatile rupee. The company will start assembling PCBs by setting up its surface-mount technology (SMT) line in collaboration with its manufacturing partner, Flex, in Sriperumbudur near Chennai.

Once the unit is functional, Huawei smartphones will be fitted with circuit boards assembled in this plant.

P. Sanjeev, vice-president (sales) of Huawei India - Consumer Business Group, told *The Economic Times*, "Deployment of the SMT line is in full swing. We will achieve full capacity in the next two months. It is a long-term effort. We are reinforcing our India-first focus for sure. This is going to swell our growth to get into top three brands."

Universal Service Obligation Fund, created under Department of Telecommunications, Ministry of Com-

munications, to provide telecom services to rural and remote areas at affordable prices. A government